



Senate

General Assembly

File No. 467

February Session, 2026

Substitute Senate Bill No. 415

Senate, April 7, 2026

The Committee on Transportation reported through SEN. COHEN of the 12th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the Senate, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT CONCERNING TRANSPORTATION NETWORK COMPANIES AND RIDER SAFETY.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 13b-116 of the general statutes is amended by
2 adding subdivisions (8) to (11), inclusive, as follows (*Effective October 1,*
3 *2026*):

4 (NEW) (8) "Telemetric monitoring" means the continuous, automated
5 collection and evaluation of operational and system performance data
6 that is generated by a digital network during a prearranged ride.

7 (NEW) (9) "Safety anomaly" means an unexpected or irregular event
8 detected through a digital network that deviates from performance
9 baselines established by a transportation network company that may
10 indicate a potential risk to the safety of a rider or driver, including, but
11 not limited to, high-force decelerations or structural vibrations
12 consistent with a motor vehicle accident, significant departures from the
13 path of the prearranged ride or prolonged periods of inactivity on the

14 digital network.

15 (NEW) (10) "Sexual assault" has the same meaning as provided in
16 section 10a-55m.

17 (NEW) (11) "Serious physical injury" has the same meaning as
18 provided in section 53a-3.

19 Sec. 2. Subsection (a) of section 13b-118 of the 2026 supplement to the
20 general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu
21 thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

22 (a) (1) A transportation network company shall provide for real-time
23 messaging between the company and the transportation network
24 company driver through the company's digital network when the driver
25 is using the digital network. Such messaging shall be available in both
26 English and Spanish.

27 (2) After a potential transportation network company rider submits a
28 request for a prearranged ride, the transportation network company
29 shall display to the rider through its digital network: [a] (A) A picture
30 of the transportation network company driver and the license plate
31 number of the transportation network company vehicle that will be
32 used to provide the prearranged ride before the rider enters such
33 vehicle, and (B) a notification identifying any safety features available
34 through the digital network that may be used during a prearranged
35 ride. Each transportation network company shall, at a minimum,
36 provide the following safety features: (i) A location sharing feature that
37 allows a rider to share information about a prearranged ride with a third
38 party, (ii) an emergency assistance interface or other means to contact a
39 public safety answering point, as defined in section 28-25, during a
40 prearranged ride, (iii) an optional audio recording feature that may be
41 utilized during a prearranged ride, provided such feature includes
42 notice to the driver and is implemented in compliance with applicable
43 state and federal laws governing the recording of communications, and
44 (iv) the availability of support and resources twenty-four hours a day to
45 manage any incidents, accidents or emergencies that occur during a

46 prearranged ride.

47 (3) On each offer for a prearranged ride presented to a transportation
48 network company driver, the transportation network company shall
49 display through its digital network on any such offer whether the
50 potential transportation network company rider requesting such
51 prearranged ride, or the third party requesting a prearranged ride on
52 behalf of a potential rider, has been verified by the company. The
53 company shall designate an individual as verified if the company has
54 authenticated the individual's identity through the submission of a valid
55 photograph, the comparison of the individual's account information
56 with records maintained by another party or any other method that
57 reasonably enables the company to confirm the identity of the
58 individual. A driver's decision to decline an offer for a prearranged ride
59 where the potential rider or requesting third party is not designated as
60 verified shall not, by itself, constitute grounds for suspension,
61 deactivation or other disciplinary action against the driver by the
62 company.

63 [(3)] (4) A transportation network company driver shall display on a
64 transportation network company vehicle a removable decal at all times
65 when the driver is connected to a digital network or is engaged in the
66 provision of a prearranged ride. Such decal shall be: (A) Issued by the
67 transportation network company; (B) sufficiently large so as to be
68 readable during daylight hours at a distance of at least fifty feet; (C)
69 reflective, illuminated or otherwise visible in darkness; and (D)
70 displayed on the passenger side of the transportation network company
71 vehicle if such decal is illuminated.

72 (5) A transportation network company shall, through its digital
73 network, (A) implement and maintain a telemetric monitoring system
74 capable of providing an emergency assistance interface with the
75 opportunity to contact a public safety answering point, and (B) permit a
76 third party pursuant to an agreement with such company to receive,
77 review and respond in real time to notifications generated by the digital
78 network relating to a safety anomaly occurring during a prearranged

79 ride.

80 Sec. 3. Section 13b-119 of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes
81 is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective*
82 *October 1, 2026*):

83 (a) Prior to permitting an individual to act as a transportation
84 network company driver on its digital network, the transportation
85 network company shall:

86 (1) Require the individual to submit an application to the company
87 that includes (A) information regarding the individual's name, address,
88 date of birth, motor vehicle operator's license number and motor vehicle
89 registration, and (B) a written statement that discloses whether the
90 individual has ever been suspended or permanently banned from
91 accessing a digital network by a transportation network company in
92 relation to any allegation of sexual assault or assault resulting in another
93 person's death or serious physical injury that was connected to the
94 driver's use of such digital network;

95 (2) (A) Conduct, or have a consumer reporting agency regulated
96 under the federal Fair Credit Reporting Act conduct, a driving record
97 check and a local, state and national criminal history records check,
98 including a search of state and national sexual offender registry
99 databases provided such databases are accessible to the public, or (B)
100 arrange for the fingerprinting of the individual to be submitted to the
101 Federal Bureau of Investigation for a national criminal history records
102 check and to the State Police Bureau of Identification for a state criminal
103 history records check conducted in accordance with section 29-17a;

104 (3) Disclose to such individual, electronically or in writing, (A) the
105 insurance coverage, including the types of coverage and any coverage
106 limits, that the company provides while a transportation network
107 company driver is connected to the company's digital network or is
108 engaged in the provision of a prearranged ride, and (B) that a
109 transportation network company driver's personal automobile
110 insurance policy might not provide coverage while such driver is

111 connected to the company's digital network, available to receive a
112 request for a prearranged ride or engaged in the provision of a
113 prearranged ride; and

114 (4) Inform such individual, electronically or in writing, (A) that such
115 individual may enroll in the Paid Family and Medical Leave Insurance
116 Program pursuant to section 31-49m and obtain information about such
117 program from the Paid Family and Medical Leave Insurance Authority
118 established in section 31-49f, (B) of the requirements to become qualified
119 to provide prearranged rides that originate in a neighboring state, and
120 (C) of the transportation network company's deactivation process for
121 transportation network company drivers. For the purposes of this
122 subdivision, "deactivation process" means procedures a transportation
123 network company undertakes to materially restrict a transportation
124 network company driver's access to the digital network, including
125 blocking access to the digital network, suspending a driver from the
126 digital network or changing a driver's status on the digital network from
127 eligible to provide prearranged rides to ineligible to provide
128 prearranged rides.

129 (b) (1) A transportation network company shall conduct, or have a
130 consumer reporting agency regulated under the federal Fair Credit
131 Reporting Act conduct, a local, state and national criminal history
132 records check, including a search of state and national sexual offender
133 registry databases, or arrange for the fingerprinting of the individual to
134 be submitted to the Federal Bureau of Investigation for a national
135 criminal history records check and to the State Police Bureau of
136 Identification for a state criminal history records check conducted in
137 accordance with section 29-17a, at least once every [three years] year
138 after permitting an individual to act as a transportation network
139 company driver.

140 (2) A transportation network company shall provide, and require
141 each transportation network company driver to complete, an annual
142 training concerning sexual assault prevention and driver education.
143 Such training shall include information regarding the prevention,

144 identification and reporting of sexual assault and instruction regarding
145 appropriate interactions with transportation network company riders.

146 (c) (1) No transportation network company shall permit an individual
147 to act as a transportation network company driver on its digital network
148 if such individual: (A) Has, during the three years prior to the date of
149 such individual's application to be a transportation network company
150 driver, (i) committed more than three moving violations, as defined in
151 section 14-111g, (ii) committed one serious traffic violation, as defined
152 in section 14-1, or (iii) had his or her motor vehicle operator's license
153 suspended pursuant to section 14-227b; (B) has been convicted, within
154 seven years prior to the date of such individual's application, of driving
155 under the influence of drugs or alcohol, fraud, sexual offenses, use of a
156 motor vehicle to commit a felony, acts of violence or acts of terror; (C) is
157 included in the state sexual offenders registry or the United States
158 Department of Justice National Sex Offender Public Website; (D) does
159 not possess a Connecticut motor vehicle operator's license or a motor
160 vehicle operator's license issued by a reciprocal state; (E) does not
161 possess proof of registration for each motor vehicle such individual
162 proposes to use as a transportation network company vehicle; [or] (F) is
163 not at least nineteen years of age; or (G) fails to submit to a periodic
164 identity verification when requested by the transportation network
165 company through its digital network when such driver is connected to
166 and active on the digital network. For the purposes of this subsection,
167 "reciprocal state" means a state that permits transportation network
168 company drivers who possess a Connecticut motor vehicle operator's
169 license to provide a prearranged ride that originates in such state.

170 (2) An individual who is permitted to act as a transportation network
171 company driver shall report to the transportation network company not
172 later than twenty-four hours after the occurrence of any of the following:
173 (A) The commission of a fourth moving violation, as defined in section
174 14-111g, during the past three years; (B) the commission of one serious
175 traffic violation, as defined in section 14-1; (C) the suspension of his or
176 her motor vehicle operator's license pursuant to section 14-227b; (D) the
177 conviction of driving under the influence of drugs or alcohol, fraud,

178 sexual offenses, use of a motor vehicle to commit a felony, acts of
179 violence or acts of terror; (E) inclusion in the state sexual offenders
180 registry or the United States Department of Justice National Sex
181 Offender Public Website; (F) failure to possess an operator's license; or
182 (G) failure to possess proof of registration for a transportation network
183 company vehicle. Each transportation network company that receives a
184 report pursuant to this subdivision or becomes aware of such
185 occurrence shall prohibit the individual from acting as a transportation
186 network company driver on the company's digital network until the
187 individual meets the qualifications of this section to be a transportation
188 network company driver.

189 (3) Not later than five days after a transportation network company
190 permanently bans a transportation network company driver's access to
191 the company's digital network due to a sexual assault or assault
192 resulting in another person's death or serious physical injury that was
193 connected to the driver's use of such digital network, such
194 transportation network company shall notify, or cause to be notified,
195 each registered transportation network company in the state of such ban
196 and the driver's first and last name, date of birth and motor vehicle
197 operator's license number.

198 (d) (1) A transportation network company shall adopt a policy that a
199 transportation network company driver shall not use or be under the
200 influence of drugs or alcohol while the driver is connected to the
201 company's digital network or engaged in the provision of a prearranged
202 ride. The company shall provide notice of such policy on its Internet
203 web site, and include procedures for a transportation network company
204 rider to report a complaint about a driver whom the rider reasonably
205 suspects was using or under the influence of drugs or alcohol while
206 engaged in the provision of a prearranged ride.

207 (2) Upon the company's receipt of a complaint by a rider alleging a
208 violation of such policy, the company shall suspend the driver's access
209 to the company's digital network as soon as possible and conduct an
210 investigation into the reported incident. The suspension shall last until

211 completion of the investigation. If the investigation confirms the driver
212 used or was under the influence of drugs or alcohol while engaged in
213 the provision of a prearranged ride or while connected to the company's
214 digital network, the company shall ban the driver's access to the digital
215 network on a permanent basis.

216 (3) The company shall maintain all records related to the enforcement
217 of such policy for a period of not less than three years from the date that
218 a complaint by a rider is received by the company.

219 (e) A transportation network company shall adopt a policy that
220 prohibits a transportation network company driver from providing a
221 prearranged ride when such driver's ability to operate a transportation
222 network company motor vehicle is impaired by illness, fatigue or any
223 other condition that would likely preclude safe operation of such
224 vehicle.

225 (f) A transportation network company driver shall: (1) Comply with
226 all applicable laws regarding nondiscrimination against transportation
227 network company riders or potential transportation network company
228 riders on the basis of age, color, creed, destination, intellectual or
229 physical disability, national origin, race, sex, sexual orientation or
230 gender identity; (2) comply with all applicable laws relating to the
231 accommodation of service animals and accommodate service animals
232 without imposing additional charges for such accommodation; (3)
233 comply with the policies adopted by the transportation network
234 company pursuant to subdivision (1) of subsection (c) of section 13b-118
235 and subsections (d) and (e) of this section; (4) not impose additional
236 charges for providing prearranged rides to persons with physical
237 disabilities because of such disabilities; and (5) not solicit or accept a
238 request for transportation unless the request is accepted through the
239 transportation network company's digital network. The Commissioner
240 of Transportation may, after notice and an opportunity for a hearing
241 pursuant to the provisions of chapter 54, impose a civil penalty of not
242 more than two hundred fifty dollars on any transportation network
243 company for each instance in which a driver using such company's

244 digital network fails to accommodate a potential rider accompanied by
245 a service animal. For the purposes of this subsection, "service animal"
246 has the same meaning as provided in section 22-345.

247 (g) (1) Any person who holds himself or herself out to be a
248 transportation network company driver who is not permitted by a
249 transportation network company to use its digital network shall be
250 guilty of a class B misdemeanor.

251 (2) The state shall remit to a municipality fifty per cent of the fine
252 amount received for a violation of subdivision (1) of this subsection with
253 respect to each summons issued by such municipality. Each clerk of the
254 Superior Court or the Chief Court Administrator, or any other official of
255 the Superior Court designated by the Chief Court Administrator, shall,
256 on or before the thirtieth day of January, April, July and October in each
257 year, certify to the Comptroller the amount due for the previous quarter
258 under this subsection to each municipality served by the office of the
259 clerk or official.

260 (h) (1) A transportation network company vehicle shall (A) have four
261 doors; (B) not be older than twelve model years old; and (C) be designed
262 to transport no more than eight passengers, including the driver.

263 (2) Before any motor vehicle is used by a transportation network
264 company driver as a transportation network company vehicle, and
265 every two years thereafter, the driver shall certify to the transportation
266 network company that the following equipment is in good working
267 order: (A) Foot brakes; (B) emergency brakes; (C) steering mechanism;
268 (D) windshield; (E) rear window and other glass; (F) windshield wipers;
269 (G) headlights; (H) tail lights; (I) turn indicator lights; (J) brake lights;
270 (K) front seat adjustment mechanism; (L) doors; (M) horn; (N)
271 speedometer; (O) bumpers; (P) muffler and exhaust system; (Q)
272 condition of tires, including tread depth; (R) interior and exterior
273 rearview mirrors; and (S) seat safety belts and air bags for driver and
274 passengers. The transportation network company shall maintain such
275 certification for not less than three years.

276 Sec. 4. Subsection (e) of section 13b-117 of the 2026 supplement to the
 277 general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu
 278 thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

279 (e) Not later than [January 1, 2026] February 1, 2027, and annually
 280 thereafter, each transportation network company registered in the state
 281 shall submit a report to the Commissioner of Transportation, in a form
 282 and manner prescribed by the commissioner. Each such report shall use
 283 aggregate data from the preceding year and include the following
 284 information: (1) The average fare collected from transportation network
 285 company riders, (2) the total time transportation network company
 286 drivers spent providing prearranged rides, and (3) the total
 287 compensation paid to transportation network company drivers for the
 288 provision of prearranged rides.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-116(8) to (11)
Sec. 2	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-118(a)
Sec. 3	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-119
Sec. 4	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-117(e)

Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-116(8) to (11)
Sec. 2	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-118(a)
Sec. 3	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-119
Sec. 4	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	13b-117(e)

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Section 2(a)(2)(B), "Such safety features shall include, but need not be limited to," was changed to "Each transportation network company shall, at a minimum, provide the following safety features:" for clarity.

TRA *Joint Favorable Subst.*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
State Revenues	GF&TF - Potential Revenue Gain	Minimal	Minimal

Note: GF&TF=General Fund & Transportation Fund

Municipal Impact:

Municipalities	Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Various Municipalities	Potential Revenue Gain	Minimal	Minimal

Explanation

The bill results in potential minimal revenue gain from fines and penalties by modifying Transportation Network Company (TNC) requirements, including a new civil penalty of up to \$250 on a TNC for each time a TNC driver fails to accommodate a rider with a service animal. Under current law, 50% of fines from certain violations of CGS. Sec. 13b-119 (Section 3 of the bill) are remitted to municipalities. Other fine revenue would go to the General Fund and civil penalty revenue to the Special Transportation Fund.

The Out Years

The annualized ongoing fiscal impact identified above would continue into the future subject to any fines or penalties imposed.

OLR Bill Analysis**sSB 415****AN ACT CONCERNING TRANSPORTATION NETWORK COMPANIES AND RIDER SAFETY.****SUMMARY**

This bill makes changes in laws on Transportation Network Companies (TNCs, such as Uber and Lyft; see below) by generally requiring them to implement certain additional rider safety measures. For example, the bill requires TNCs to provide certain safety features to riders and notify them of these features.

The bill also includes various provisions specifically related to sexual assault and assault prevention, such as requiring (1) potential drivers to disclose in their application to a TNC instances of prior discipline related to allegations of sexual assault or assault and (2) TNCs to provide, and require each TNC driver to complete, an annual training on sexual assault prevention and driver education.

It also authorizes the transportation commissioner, after giving notice and a hearing opportunity according to the Uniform Administrative Procedure Act, to impose a civil penalty of up to \$250 on any TNC for each time a driver using the company's digital network fails to accommodate a potential rider with a service animal. By law, TNC drivers must (1) comply with all applicable laws related to accommodating service animals and (2) accommodate service animals at no additional charge.

Lastly, the bill delays, from January 1, 2026, to February 1, 2027, the date by which Connecticut-registered TNCs must begin to annually report certain aggregate data to the transportation commissioner (the average fare collected from TNC riders, the total time TNC drivers spent giving prearranged rides, and the total compensation paid to drivers for

these rides).

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

TRANSPORTATION NETWORK COMPANIES

By law, unchanged by the bill, TNCs are business entities that operate in Connecticut and use a digital network (generally an online-enabled application, website, or system) to connect TNC riders to TNC drivers for prearranged rides. (They do not include taxicab certificate or livery permit holders.) TNC drivers are not TNC employees and use vehicles meeting certain requirements to provide these rides while connected to a digital network. A “prearranged ride” is one that starts when a TNC driver accepts a ride request through the digital network and ends when the rider exits the vehicle.

RIDER SAFETY REQUIREMENTS

Notice of Required Safety Features

After a potential TNC rider requests a prearranged ride, the bill requires TNCs, through their digital network, to notify the rider about any available safety features that can be used during the ride. The bill requires TNCs to provide at least the following features:

1. location sharing allowing a rider to share information about the ride with a third party;
2. an emergency assistance interface or other way to contact a public safety answering point;
3. optional audio recording, which must notify the driver when in use and comply with applicable state and federal laws on recording communications; and
4. available 24-hour support and resources for managing any ride-related incidents, accidents, or emergencies.

Under the bill and existing law, a “public safety answering point” is generally a facility that receives 9-1-1 calls and dispatches emergency response services or transfers calls to other public safety agencies.

Telemetric Monitoring

The bill requires TNCs, through their digital network, to (1) have a telemetric monitoring system capable of providing an emergency assistance interface (see above) and (2) allow a third party, through an agreement with the company, to receive, review, and respond in real time to digital network-generated notifications of safety anomalies occurring during a prearranged ride.

Under the bill, “telemetric monitoring” is the continuous, automated collection and evaluation of operational and system performance data that a digital network generates during a ride. A “safety anomaly” is generally an unexpected event, detected by a digital network, that deviates from a TNC’s performance baselines and may indicate a potential safety risk for a driver or rider (for example, indications of a vehicle accident, departure from the prearranged ride path, or prolonged period of inactivity on the digital network).

New Driver Applications and Annual Training

Existing law requires TNCs to take certain actions before allowing a person to drive for the company, including requiring potential drivers to submit an application with their name, address, birthdate, and driver’s license number and vehicle registration. The bill additionally requires the application to include a written statement disclosing whether the person has ever been suspended or permanently banned by a TNC from its digital network related to any allegation of sexual assault or assault that caused someone’s death or serious injury connected with the driver’s digital network use.

Under the bill, a “sexual assault” includes 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th degree sexual assault, aggravated sexual assault, or sexual assault with a firearm. A “serious physical injury” is one that creates a substantial risk of death or that causes serious disfigurement, health impairment, or impairment or loss of bodily organ function.

The bill also requires TNCs to provide an annual training on sexual assault prevention and driver education, which they must require each

TNC driver to complete. The training must include (1) information on preventing, identifying, and reporting sexual assault and (2) instruction on appropriate interactions with riders.

Driver Identity Verification, Background Checks, and Bans

Existing law prohibits TNCs from allowing someone to work as a TNC driver for various reasons, such as certain motor vehicle violations and offenses or their inclusion on a state or national sex offender registry. The bill adds to this list failure to submit periodic identity verification when a TNC requests it through the digital network and the driver is connected to and active on the network.

The bill increases the frequency of the criminal history records checks TNCs must conduct for each person permitted to drive for the company, to annually rather than every three years as current law requires.

Additionally, the bill requires TNCs to notify (or cause to be notified) each Connecticut-registered TNC within five days after banning a driver's access to the company's digital network due to a sexual assault or assault resulting in another person's death or serious physical injury (see above) connected with the driver's digital network use. Under the bill, this notice must include the driver's first and last name, birthdate, and driver's license number.

RIDER IDENTITY VERIFICATION

Under the bill, when drivers are offered a prearranged ride, the TNC must display through its digital network whether the requesting rider (or third party requesting the ride on their behalf) is verified by the company. A TNC must designate someone as verified if the company has authenticated their identity using certain means (submission of a valid photograph, comparison of the person's account with records another party maintains, or any other method that reasonably allows the company to confirm their identity).

The bill specifies that if a driver declines a ride offer for someone who is unverified, this does not alone give the TNC grounds to take disciplinary action against the driver, including suspension or

deactivation (restricting their access to the digital network).

COMMITTEE ACTION

Transportation Committee

Joint Favorable Substitute

Yea 36 Nay 0 (03/16/2026)